Where Dad's Records Are and Who Can Reach Them

An organizer for families planning ahead: where each kind of record is kept, when it was last updated, and the blanks.

Dad's statements are in the roll-top desk, his insurance papers are somewhere in the hall closet, and the only person who knows the whole system is Dad.

This page doesn't ask you to understand any of it, or to move anything. It asks where each kind of record is kept, when it was last updated, and who besides Dad can reach it. Fill it in with him.

WHAT TO LIST	WHERE IT'S KEPT	LAST UPDATED	WHO CAN REACH IT
Bank statements, and whether they come on paper or online			
Records for any other accounts, such as investment or retirement accounts			
Income paperwork: the letters and statements that show what comes in			
Property papers: the deed if he owns his home, and the papers for anything else he owns			
Insurance policies and cards			
Important legal documents, and where the signed originals are			
Care-related paperwork: his doctors' names, and anything they've given him worth keeping			
The family contact list			
The professionals Dad already uses, with their phone numbers			
The storage place itself: the drawer, box or online folder, and how a second person would get into it			
The family's own notes: who would handle what, the changes you've written down, the next review date			

What's missing, and who will look for it

Anything above with an empty line, and any record only one person can reach. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE Nobody but Dad has seen the deed. He thinks it's in the safe-deposit box. Karen will go with him to look next month.

How to use it

- Say where each thing is. Don't copy account numbers or passwords onto this page.
- For “last updated”, write the date on the most recent statement, or the date a document was signed. If you can't tell, write “undated” or “don't know”.
- Don't rewrite or summarize a document here, and don't move anything without Dad.
- Put today's date on the page and keep it with the records.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any record means, say which records Medicaid would ask for in Dad's state, or tell you whether a document is still right for him. If you read something you don't understand, that's a question for the person who wrote it or for the appropriate professional. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where each kind of record is kept, who can reach it, and which ones nobody has seen lately. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring, along with this page, to any conversation about paying for care.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The rows for statements, the storage place and the professionals' contact details follow the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau's advice on keeping financial documents organized where a trusted person can find them. The rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Planning for diminished capacity and illness